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# T&E Implementation Checklist

47 actions covering discovery, vendor selection, configuration, testing, and go-live for Travel & Expense system implementations.

47 Action Items

5 Phases

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47 items

5 phases

UAT scripts

KPI metrics

## T&E Implementation Checklist

47 action items

This checklist covers the 47 actions most commonly missed in Travel & Expense system implementations across European markets. Use it to structure your project plan, track completion, and prepare for each phase gate.

### Phase 1 — Discovery and Scoping

- ☐ Map current T&E process end-to-end — from expense submission to ERP posting
- ☐ Document current approval hierarchy and identify all exception workflows
- ☐ Identify all entities, countries, and currencies in scope
- ☐ Confirm number of active expense users and card programme participants
- ☐ Extract last 12 months of T&E transaction data for volume and category analysis
- ☐ Document all current policy thresholds by category and country
- ☐ Identify integration requirements: ERP, HRIS, payroll, corporate card provider
- ☐ Confirm data retention and archiving requirements by jurisdiction
- ☐ Map all current VAT reclaim processes and identify impact of automation
- ☐ Identify any regulatory reporting obligations (per diem rules, HMRC, AEAT, etc.)

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## Phase 2 — Vendor Selection

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- ☐ Define mandatory requirements and weighting criteria for RFP scoring
- ☐ Confirm ERP connector version and certification status with shortlisted vendors
- ☐ Request and verify references from comparable-size implementations in your sector
- ☐ Require proof-of-concept on your ERP version before contract signature
- ☐ Confirm OCR accuracy rate on sample of your own historical receipts
- ☐ Review SLA terms for processing time, uptime, and support response
- ☐ Confirm data residency and GDPR compliance for all entities in scope
- ☐ Negotiate contract exit rights and data portability provisions

## Phase 3 — Configuration and Build

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- ☐ Configure expense categories to match ERP chart of accounts
- ☐ Build approval rules matching current hierarchy — test all exception paths
- ☐ Configure per diem rates for all countries in scope
- ☐ Set up policy enforcement rules with soft and hard stops by category
- ☐ Configure VAT codes and reclaim rules by country
- ☐ Build integration mapping between T&E system and ERP (cost centre, GL, project codes)
- ☐ Configure corporate card feed — test settlement and reconciliation workflow
- ☐ Set up audit sampling rules and flagging logic for finance controls
- ☐ Build custom reports: policy compliance, category spend, approval cycle time
- ☐ Configure mobile app for all supported device types used in the organisation

## Phase 4 — Testing

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- ☐ Execute end-to-end UAT for standard expense claim: submission to ERP posting
  - ☐ Test all exception scenarios: out-of-policy, missing receipt, multi-currency
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- ☐ Test approval workflow for all hierarchy levels and delegation scenarios
  - ☐ Verify ERP posting accuracy across all GL codes and cost centres
  - ☐ Test VAT reclaim extraction and confirm accuracy against manual baseline
  - ☐ Verify mobile app performance on all supported devices
  - ☐ Conduct parallel run: process 50 real claims through both old and new system
  - ☐ Test period-end reconciliation between T&E system and ERP trial balance
  - ☐ Confirm audit trail completeness for a sample of test transactions
  - ☐ Obtain written UAT sign-off from Finance, IT, and business representative
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#### Phase 5 — Go-Live and Hypercare

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- ☐ Complete user training — all expense submitters, approvers, and finance admins
  - ☐ Publish updated T&E policy aligned to new system capabilities
  - ☐ Communicate go-live date and support arrangements to all affected users
  - ☐ Confirm hypercare support arrangement with vendor (minimum 4 weeks)
  - ☐ Monitor auto-match rate and processing time daily for first 2 weeks
  - ☐ Establish weekly hypercare call with vendor for first 4 weeks
  - ☐ Track open defects and ensure all P1/P2 issues resolved within agreed SLA
  - ☐ Complete first month-end close using new system — verify ERP reconciliation
  - ☐ Measure KPIs at 30 days: auto-match rate, cycle time, policy compliance rate
  - ☐ Conduct formal post-implementation review at 90 days against business case
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## About This Resource

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This checklist was developed by **Mirela Dragulescu**, a finance transformation specialist with 9+ years delivering T&E platform implementations across 10+ European markets including SAP Concur, Expensify, Payhawk, and Yokoy deployments.

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### RELATED RESOURCES

The **T&E Vendor Evaluation Scorecard** (premium, €25) provides a 40-criterion weighted scoring matrix for comparing T&E platforms. The **T&E Vendor Evaluation Scorecard — Premium Edition** (€45) adds implementation risk scoring and contract negotiation guidance.

Available in the Resources section on MD Consulting's website.

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